STRAY DOGS

A War On Delhi Strays

On August 11, the Supreme Court ignited a heated debate with a blanket suo motu order that all stray dogs in Delhi and the National Capital Region (NCR) be removed and rehabilitated in permanent shelters. Justices J.B. Pardiwala and R. Mahadevan said the condition concerning dog bites is "extremely grim" and that children must not fall prey to rabies. A three-judge bench is now scheduled to take up the matter

Text by **AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR**
Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY/AI**

THE SC ORDER

- Civic bodies to ready shelters, pick up 5,000 dogs in Delhi-NCR in 6-8 weeks
- Each shelter to house 5,000-6,000 dogs, have CCTV cameras, sterilisation facilities, trained staff
- No release of dogs into public spaces, nullifying provisions of the Animal Birth Control (ABC) Rules, 2001, that mandates release of dogs to their localities after sterilisation and immunisation
- "Absurd, unreasonable", judges call the ABC rule. "Why should that stray dog come back to that locality... for what?"

THE TRIGGER: A CHILD'S DEATH

On July 28, 2025, the SC took suo motu cognisance of a July 6 newspaper report about the death of six-year-old Chhavi Sharma from Pooth Kalan in Delhi after catching rabies from a dog bite

